Business Scenarios

Module 10

Module Objectives

- To understand the Business Scenario technique
- To understand where it is used in TOGAF

Introduction

Key factors in the success of any enterprise architecture are:

- the extent to which it is linked to **business requirements**
- its support for **business objectives**

Business scenarios help us to identify and understand the business requirements that the architecture development must address

What is a Business Scenario?

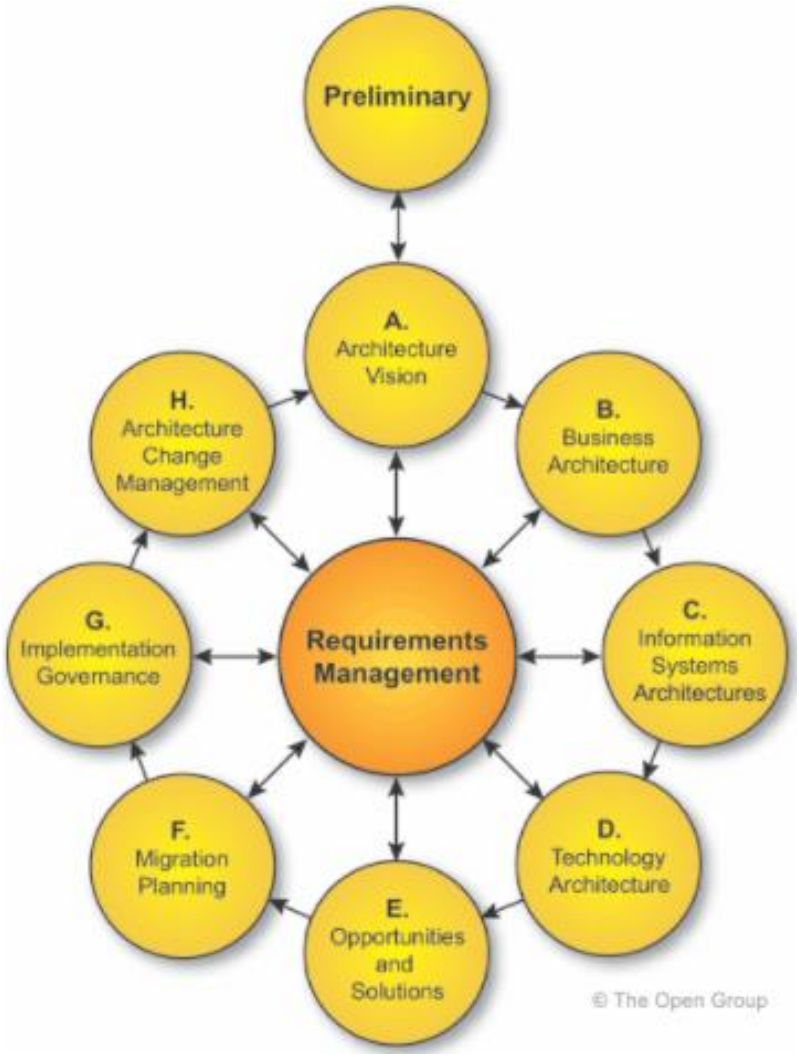
A business scenario describes

- **a business process**, application or set of applications that can be enabled by the architecture
- the business and technology **environment**
- **the people** who execute it
- the desired **outcome** of proper execution

Business Scenarios

- TOGAF defines a method for developing Business Scenarios
  - **A method within a method**
  - Documented in PART III, ADM Guidelines and Techniques

Business Scenarios and the ADM



- Used clearly in **Phase A** and iteratively in **Phase B**
- **Business Requirements** are referred to throughout all phases of the ADM

What is a Good Business Scenario?

A good business scenario:

- is representative of a significant **business need** or problem
- enables vendors to understand **the value** of a developed solution to a customer
- is **SMART**

SMART

- **Specific**
  - defines what needs to be done in the business
- **Measurable**
  - has clear metrics for success
- **Actionable**
  - clearly segments the problem, and provides basis for a solution
- **Realistic**
  - defines the bounds of capability and cost constraints
- **Time-bound**
  - Gives a clear understanding of when solution expires

Benefits of Business Scenarios

It should be a complete description of a business problem. Without it;

- The requirements won't be **complete**
- The **business value** will be unclear
- The relevance of potential solutions will be **unclear**

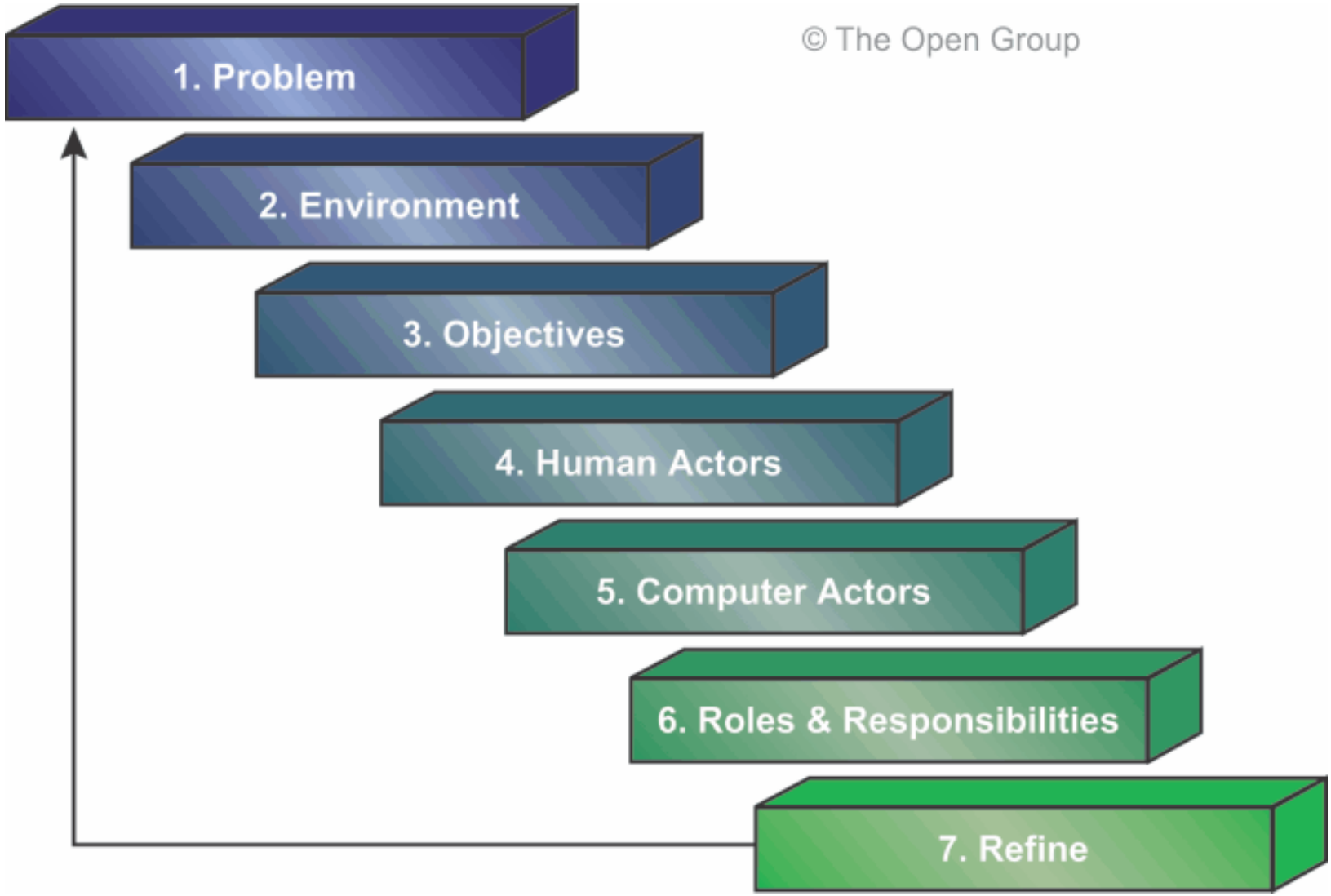
A scenario

- can play an important role in **stakeholder engagement**
- can help to establish good **vendor communication**

Who Contributes to a Business Scenario?

- Not fully responsibility of the architect
- **Business line management** and other stakeholders must be involved
- It may also involve **IT vendors**
- Involvement of the management in **early stages**, involvement of the architect in **later stages**

Developing a Business Scenario



Getting Business Scenarios Right

- Customers almost always know what they want
  - so help them **write** it down
- Customers sometimes don't know what they really need
  - so help discover **what's needed**
  - help bring out critical **business rules**
  - focus **on what** not the how
- Business Scenarios are part of a **larger process**, not an end.

Contents of a Business Scenario

- Business Scenario models should
  - capture **business** and **technology** views graphically
  - provide a starting point for requirements
  - relate **actors** and **interactions**
- Business Scenario descriptions should
  - capture critical steps between actors in the reight sequence
  - partition the responsibility of the actors
  - **list pre-conditions** that have to be met prior to system functionality
  - provide technical requirements to ensure the service is of **acceptable quality**

Template for a Business Scenario

- Problem Description
- Detailed Objectives
- Views of environments and processes
- Actors, roles and responsibilities
- Principles and constraints
- Requirements
- Next steps
- Glossary
- References



Resources

- The Open Group Bookstore
  - The Managers Guide to Business Scenarios
  - Examples of completed Business Scenarios

www.opengroup.org/bookstore

Summary

- Business scenarios help address one of the most common issues facing businesses
  - **Aligning IT** with business
- Business scenarios help to identify and understand **business needs**
- They are just a **technique**, not the goal
  - They are part of the larger process of architecture development